

9. Clauses

Definition and Introduction

A clause is a group of words that contains a subject and a verb. It may or may not express a complete idea. Clauses are the building blocks of sentences and help add meaning and detail. There are different kinds of clauses used for different purposes. Understanding clauses helps in sentence formation and editing questions.

She said that she was tired.

I know what he wants.

We stayed where the road ended.

He worked hard because he was poor.

This is the place where I was born.

Noun Clause

A noun clause functions as a noun in a sentence. It can act as a subject, object, or complement. Noun clauses often begin with words like that, what, who, whom, or whether. They answer questions such as what or who. They are commonly tested in sentence transformation and identification.

What he said was true.

I know that he is honest.

She asked whether I was ready.

Tell me who broke the glass.

This is what I wanted.

Adverb Clause

An adverb clause modifies a verb, adjective, or another adverb. It tells about time, place, reason, condition, manner, or concession. It usually begins with a subordinating conjunction. Adverb clauses add extra information to sentences. They are important in complex sentence construction.

I will go where you go.

Call me when you arrive.

He failed because he did not study.

Although he is rich, he is unhappy.

If it rains, we will stay inside.

Adverb Clause of place



An adverb clause of place shows where an action happens. It usually begins with words like where or wherever. It answers the question 'where?'. Such clauses modify verbs of movement or position. They help describe location clearly.

Sit where you like.

I will follow you wherever you go.

This is the place where we met.

He lives where the river bends.

Stay where you are.

Adverb Clause of time

An adverb clause of time shows when an action happens. It is introduced by words like when, while, before, after, or since. It answers the question 'when?'. These clauses are common in narratives. They help show sequence of events.

When the bell rang, we left.

I was sleeping when you called.

After he finished work, he rested.

While she was reading, it rained.

Since he came, things changed.

Adverb Clause of cause/reason

An adverb clause of reason shows why something happens. It is introduced by words like because, since, or as. It answers the question 'why?'. Such clauses explain cause or reason. They are frequently used in explanatory writing.

He failed because he was careless.

Since it was raining, we stayed inside.

As he was ill, he rested.

I stayed home because I was tired.

She cried as she was hurt.

Adverb Clause of concession

An adverb clause of concession shows contrast or unexpected result. It is introduced by although, though, even though, or whereas. It shows opposition between ideas. Such clauses add emphasis and contrast. They are common in formal writing.

Although he is poor, he is honest.

Though it was cold, we went out.

Even though he tried, he failed.

Whereas she likes tea, I prefer coffee.

Though she was tired, she worked.

Adverb Clause condition

An adverb clause of condition states a condition for something to happen. It usually begins with *if*, *unless*, or *provided that*. It answers the question 'under what condition?'. Such clauses are important in conditional sentences. They are tested in grammar and sentence correction.

If it rains, we will cancel the trip.

Unless you hurry, you will miss the bus.

Provided that you work hard, you will succeed.

If he calls, tell me.

Unless you study, you will fail.

Adverb Clause conditional tenses

Conditional clauses use different tenses to show real or unreal situations. Type 1 shows possible conditions. Type 2 shows imaginary present situations. Type 3 shows unreal past situations. Understanding these helps in sentence transformation.

If it rains, I will stay home.

If I were rich, I would help the poor.

If he had studied, he would have passed.

If you work hard, you will succeed.

If she knew the answer, she would reply.

Adverb Clause of manner

An adverb clause of manner shows how an action is done. It is introduced by words like *as*, *as if*, or *as though*. It answers the question 'how?'. These clauses describe the way an action happens. They add detail to sentences.

Do as I say.

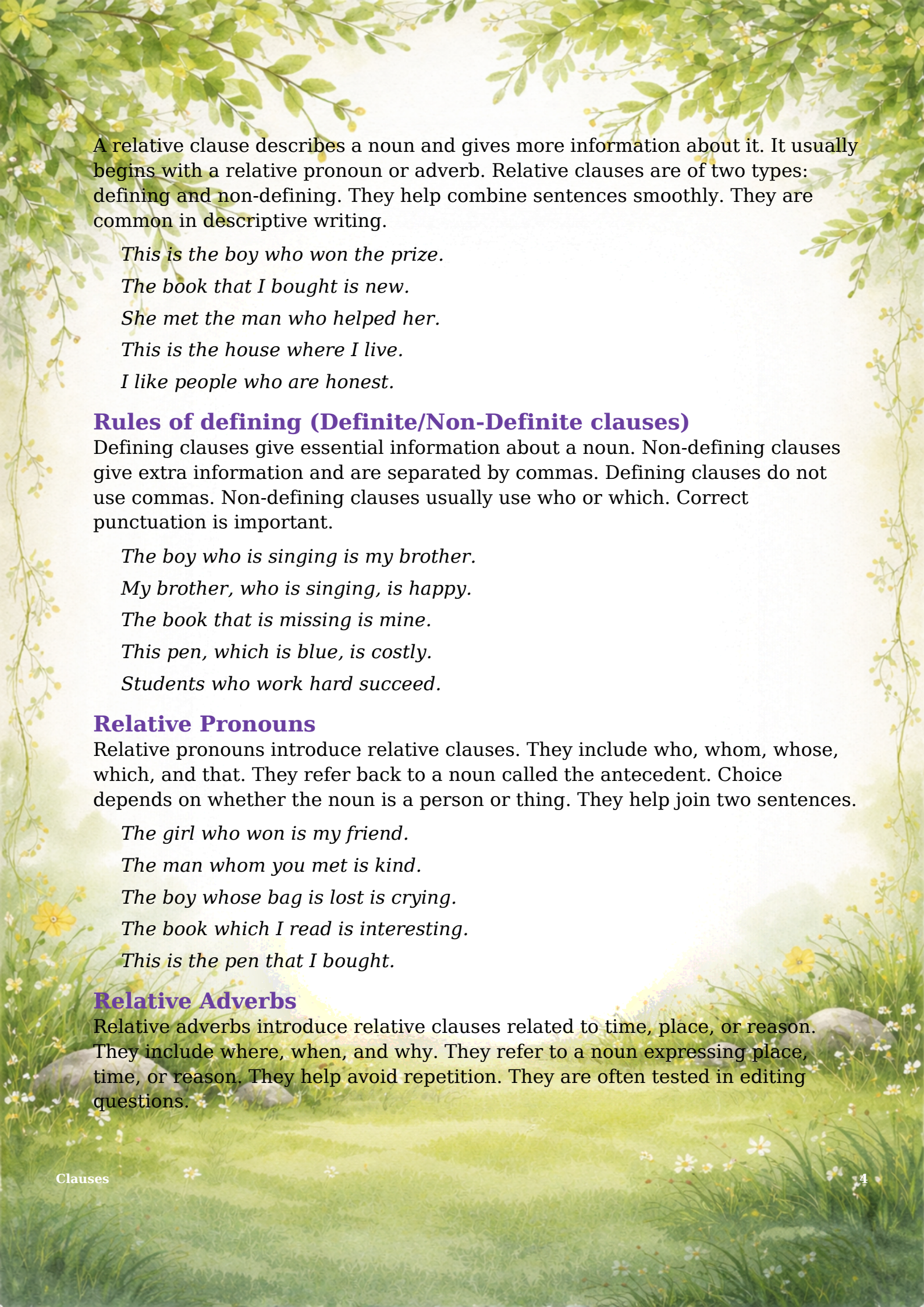
He talks as if he knows everything.

She behaved as though she were angry.

Work as your teacher advises.

He walked as if he was tired.

Relative Clause



A relative clause describes a noun and gives more information about it. It usually begins with a relative pronoun or adverb. Relative clauses are of two types: defining and non-defining. They help combine sentences smoothly. They are common in descriptive writing.

This is the boy who won the prize.

The book that I bought is new.

She met the man who helped her.

This is the house where I live.

I like people who are honest.

Rules of defining (Definite/Non-Definite clauses)

Defining clauses give essential information about a noun. Non-defining clauses give extra information and are separated by commas. Defining clauses do not use commas. Non-defining clauses usually use who or which. Correct punctuation is important.

The boy who is singing is my brother.

My brother, who is singing, is happy.

The book that is missing is mine.

This pen, which is blue, is costly.

Students who work hard succeed.

Relative Pronouns

Relative pronouns introduce relative clauses. They include who, whom, whose, which, and that. They refer back to a noun called the antecedent. Choice depends on whether the noun is a person or thing. They help join two sentences.

The girl who won is my friend.

The man whom you met is kind.

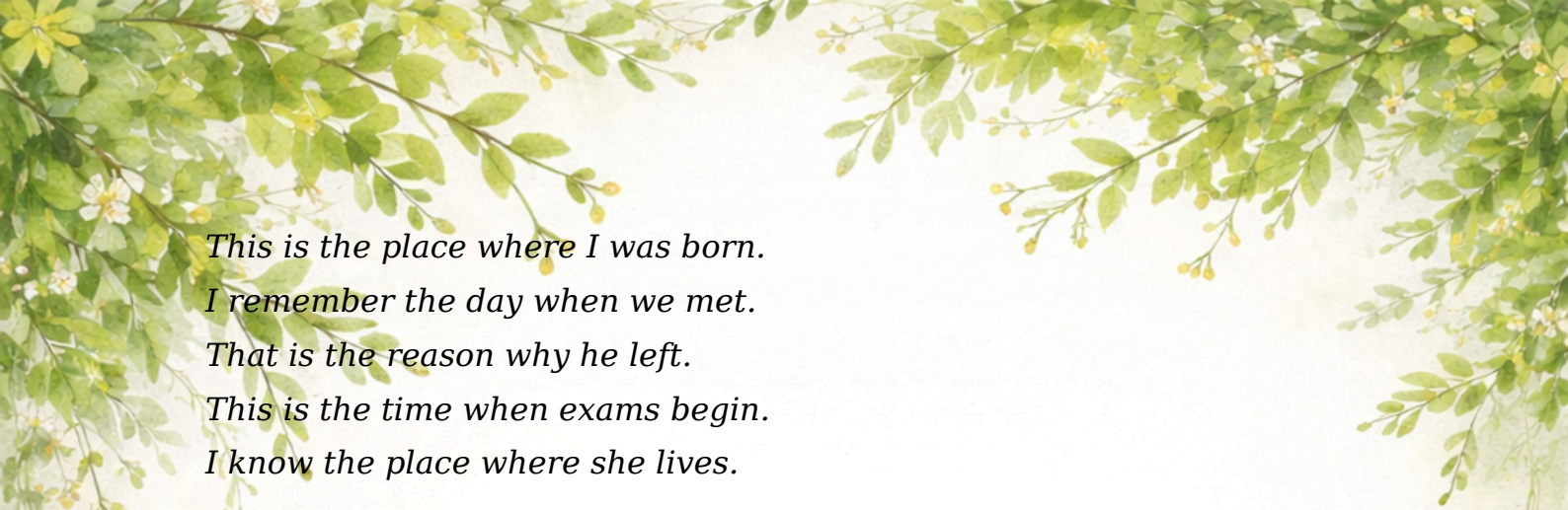
The boy whose bag is lost is crying.

The book which I read is interesting.

This is the pen that I bought.

Relative Adverbs

Relative adverbs introduce relative clauses related to time, place, or reason. They include where, when, and why. They refer to a noun expressing place, time, or reason. They help avoid repetition. They are often tested in editing questions.



*This is the place where I was born.
I remember the day when we met.
That is the reason why he left.
This is the time when exams begin.
I know the place where she lives.*

Interrogatives Clause

An interrogative clause is used to ask indirect questions. It begins with wh-words like what, who, when, where, or how. It does not follow question word order. Such clauses function as noun clauses. They are common in reported speech.

*I asked what he wanted.
She knows where he lives.
Tell me why you are late.
I wonder how he solved it.
Do you know when the train arrives?*

when w word is Clause and when not.

A wh-word forms a clause when it has its own subject and verb. It does not form a clause if it is just a single word or phrase. Check whether a verb follows the wh-word. If there is a subject and verb, it is a clause. This helps in identification questions.

*I know what he said. (clause)
I know what book he bought. (clause)
What a day! (not a clause)
Which book? (not a clause)
She explained why she was late. (clause)*

Exercises

1. Identify the Clause used in the following sentences:

- (i) I know that he is honest.
- (ii) This is the place where I was born.
- (iii) She said that she was tired.
- (iv) He worked hard because he was poor.
- (v) The boy who is singing is my brother.
- (vi) I will go when you come.
- (vii) Tell me what you want.
- (viii) She behaved as if she were angry.
- (ix) If it rains, we will stay inside.
- (x) I remember the day when we met.

2. Fill in the blanks with the correct form of the Clause given in brackets:

- (i) I know ____ he is telling the truth. (noun clause)
- (ii) This is the place ____ I was born. (adverb clause of place)
- (iii) Call me ____ you arrive. (adverb clause of time)
- (iv) He failed ____ he did not study. (adverb clause of reason)
- (v) ____ it rains, we will stay inside. (conditional clause)
- (vi) She speaks ____ she knows everything. (manner clause)
- (vii) The boy ____ won the prize is my friend. (relative clause)
- (viii) I asked ____ he was late. (interrogative clause)
- (ix) This is the reason ____ he left. (relative adverb)
- (x) I wonder ____ she will agree. (noun clause)

3. Choose the correct option:

- (i) I know ____ he is coming.
 - (a) that
 - (b) where
 - (c) when

- 
- (d) who
- (ii) This is the place ____ we met.
- (a) which
- (b) where
- (c) that
- (d) who
- (iii) He failed ____ he was careless.
- (a) when
- (b) because
- (c) who
- (d) which
- (iv) The boy ____ won is my cousin.
- (a) which
- (b) where
- (c) who
- (d) when
- (v) I will call you ____ I arrive.
- (a) because
- (b) when
- (c) that
- (d) who
- (vi) She behaved ____ she were angry.
- (a) as if
- (b) because
- (c) when
- (d) that
- (vii) The book ____ I bought is new.
- (a) who
- (b) where
- (c) that
- (d) when
- (viii) Tell me ____ you want.

- 
- (a) which
 - (b) that
 - (c) what
 - (d) where

4. Match the following:

List A

- 1. Noun Clause
- 2. Adverb Clause of Time
- 3. Relative Clause
- 4. Adverb Clause of Reason
- 5. Conditional Clause

List B

- A. that he is honest
- B. when the bell rang
- C. who won the prize
- D. because he was ill
- E. if it rains

5. Identify the type of Clause used:

- (i) I know what he said.
- (ii) This is the boy who won the prize.
- (iii) Call me when you arrive.
- (iv) He stayed home because he was ill.
- (v) If you work hard, you will succeed.
- (vi) She behaved as if she were angry.
- (vii) I remember the day when we met.
- (viii) Tell me where you live.
- (ix) This is the reason why he left.
- (x) The book that I bought is new.

6. Multiple choice questions:

- (i) The man ____ helped me was kind.
 - (a) which
 - (b) who
 - (c) when
 - (d) where
- (ii) I will stay here ____ you return.

- 
- (a) because
(b) when
(c) who
(d) that
- (iii) She knows ___ he lives.
(a) that
(b) where
(c) who
(d) when
- (iv) The reason ___ he failed is clear.
(a) which
(b) why
(c) who
(d) when
- (v) ___ it rains, we will cancel the trip.
(a) Although
(b) If
(c) Because
(d) When
- (vi) This is the house ___ I live.
(a) which
(b) where
(c) that
(d) when
- (vii) He spoke ___ he knew everything.
(a) as if
(b) because
(c) when
(d) that
- (viii) Tell me ___ you are late.
(a) what
(b) why

- 
- (c) which
(d) who
- (ix) The girl ___ bag is lost is crying.
(a) who
(b) whose
(c) which
(d) that
- (x) I know the time ___ he arrived.
(a) when
(b) where
(c) why
(d) who

7. Spot the error in the following sentences and correct it:

- (i) This is the place which I was born.
(ii) He failed because of he was careless.
(iii) The boy which won the prize is my friend.
(iv) I will call you because I arrive.
(v) She behaved as she was angry.
(vi) Tell me that you want.
(vii) This is the reason that he left.
(viii) If he will work hard, he will succeed.
(ix) The man who bag is lost is crying.
(x) I know the time where he came.

8. Correct the following paragraph:

I know that he is honest. He lives in the house which he was born. When he will come, we will start. The boy which won the prize is my cousin. She cried because of she was hurt. Tell me that you want. This is the reason that he failed. If he will study, he will pass. I remember the day where we met. The girl who bag is missing is crying. I stayed home because it was raining. Call me when you will arrive. He spoke as he knew everything. This is the place which I live. I



know the time where he came. The man which helped me was kind. She behaved as she was angry. If you will work hard, you will succeed. I asked that he was late. This is the book which I bought.



Answer Sheet

1. Identify the Clause:

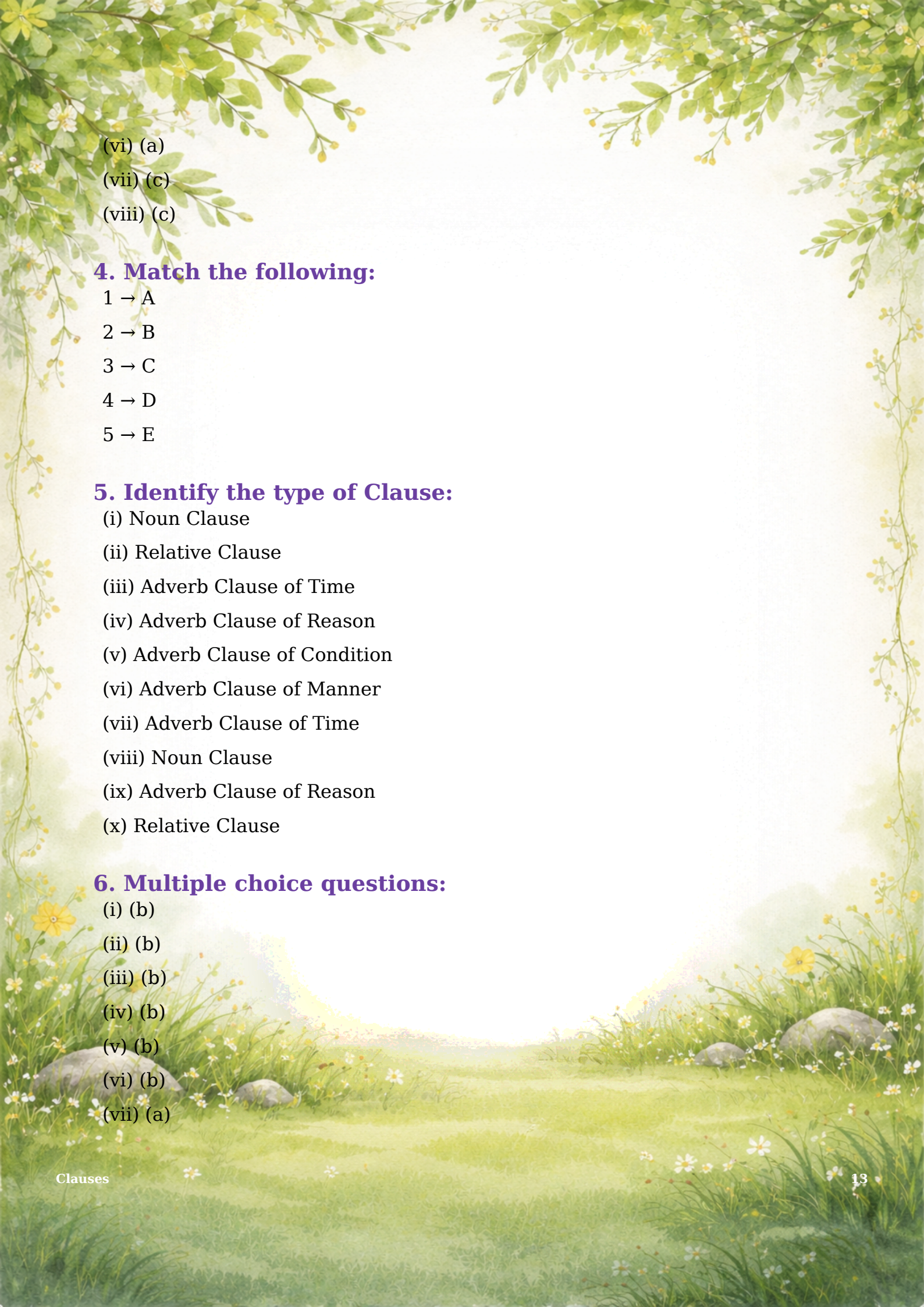
- (i) Noun Clause
- (ii) Adverb Clause of Place
- (iii) Noun Clause
- (iv) Adverb Clause of Reason
- (v) Relative Clause
- (vi) Adverb Clause of Time
- (vii) Noun Clause
- (viii) Adverb Clause of Manner
- (ix) Adverb Clause of Condition
- (x) Adverb Clause of Time

2. Fill in the blanks:

- (i) that
- (ii) where
- (iii) when
- (iv) because
- (v) If
- (vi) as if
- (vii) who
- (viii) why
- (ix) why
- (x) whether

3. Choose the correct option:

- (i) (a)
- (ii) (b)
- (iii) (b)
- (iv) (c)
- (v) (b)

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- (vi) (a)
(vii) (c)
(viii) (c)

4. Match the following:

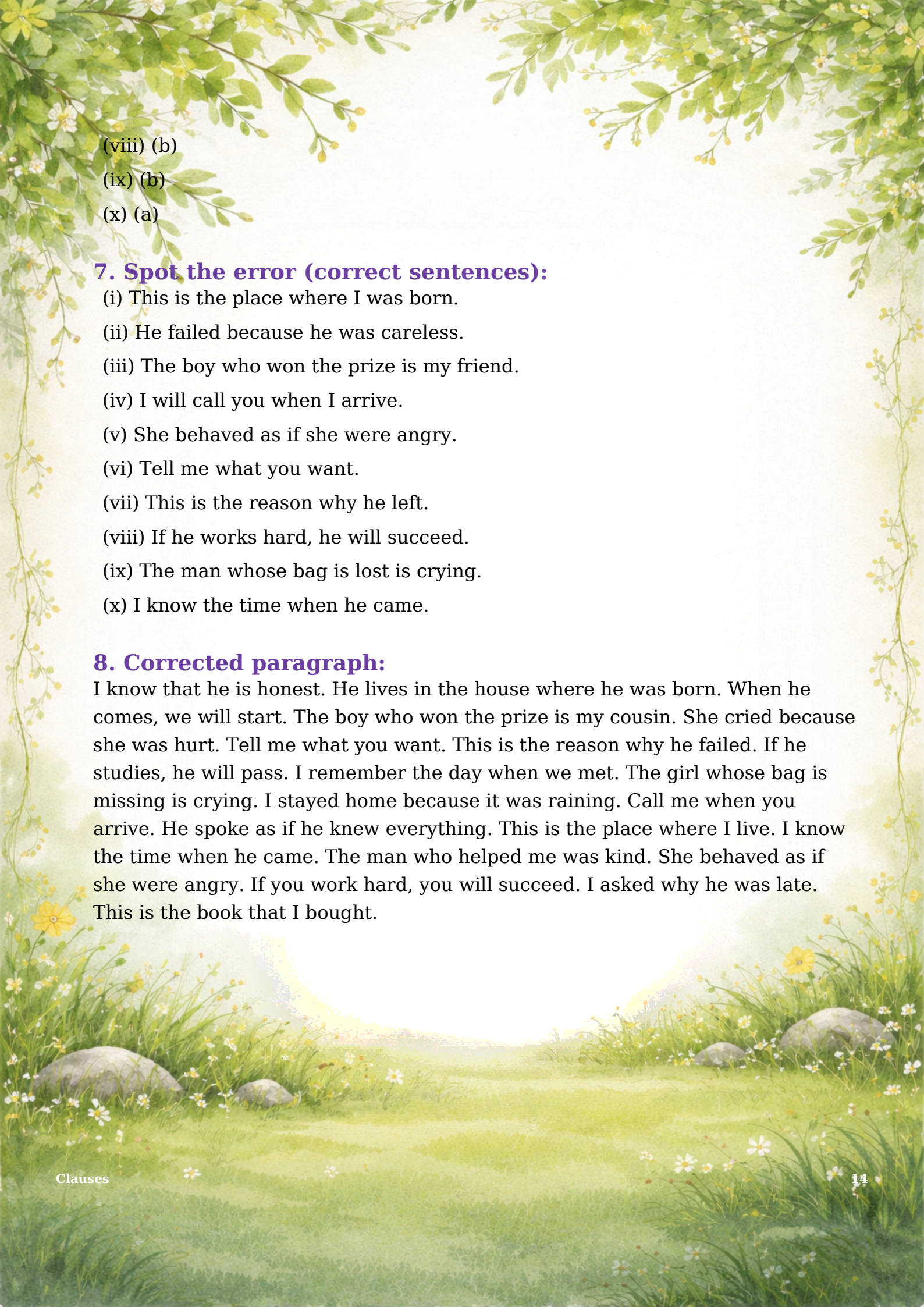
- 1 → A
2 → B
3 → C
4 → D
5 → E

5. Identify the type of Clause:

- (i) Noun Clause
(ii) Relative Clause
(iii) Adverb Clause of Time
(iv) Adverb Clause of Reason
(v) Adverb Clause of Condition
(vi) Adverb Clause of Manner
(vii) Adverb Clause of Time
(viii) Noun Clause
(ix) Adverb Clause of Reason
(x) Relative Clause

6. Multiple choice questions:

- (i) (b)
(ii) (b)
(iii) (b)
(iv) (b)
(v) (b)
(vi) (b)
(vii) (a)



(viii) (b)

(ix) (b)

(x) (a)

7. Spot the error (correct sentences):

- (i) This is the place where I was born.
- (ii) He failed because he was careless.
- (iii) The boy who won the prize is my friend.
- (iv) I will call you when I arrive.
- (v) She behaved as if she were angry.
- (vi) Tell me what you want.
- (vii) This is the reason why he left.
- (viii) If he works hard, he will succeed.
- (ix) The man whose bag is lost is crying.
- (x) I know the time when he came.

8. Corrected paragraph:

I know that he is honest. He lives in the house where he was born. When he comes, we will start. The boy who won the prize is my cousin. She cried because she was hurt. Tell me what you want. This is the reason why he failed. If he studies, he will pass. I remember the day when we met. The girl whose bag is missing is crying. I stayed home because it was raining. Call me when you arrive. He spoke as if he knew everything. This is the place where I live. I know the time when he came. The man who helped me was kind. She behaved as if she were angry. If you work hard, you will succeed. I asked why he was late. This is the book that I bought.